

Marta has a spreadsheet problem.

This is the conversation that followed — with her finance director, her shift lead, and us. It took eleven weeks. Nothing in it is unusual.

Rotterdam

90 employees

Logistics

PREPARED BY

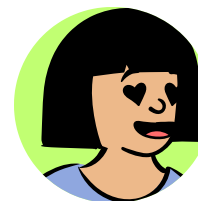
Nexarrow OÜ · Tallinn, Estonia

NEXARROW.EU

REG. 17521430 · VAT EE102992676



THE CAST



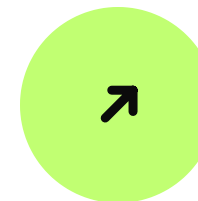
Marta
Operations



Joost
Finance



Sanne
Shift lead



Nexarrow
Us



WHO IS IN THIS

NEXARROW OÜ · A CONVERSATION

Four people, and four different worries.



Marta Visser

Operations Director

Runs the depots. Knows exactly where the process leaks because she is the one people call when it does.

WORRIES ABOUT

“Will this actually change anything, or is it another system nobody uses?”



Joost de Wit

Finance Director

Signs the invoices. Has been burned once by a supplier who disappeared after final payment.

WORRIES ABOUT

“Who exactly are we contracting with, and where does our data end up?”



Sanne Bakker

Shift Lead, Rotterdam depot

Actually uses the spreadsheet, forty times a day. Was not asked the last time software was bought.

WORRIES ABOUT

“Is this going to make my shift slower for three months?”



Nexarrow

Estonian software company

Small, EU-registered, engineers in India, live in the European afternoon. Builds internal systems.

WORRIES ABOUT

“Are we solving the right problem, or just the one we were handed?”



It started, as it usually does, with a lorry in the wrong city.

Two depots, one file, and two people editing it at the same time. By the time anyone noticed, a 22-tonne load had been dispatched to Antwerp instead of Rotterdam.

€4,100

cost of that single mistake

6 hrs

to work out what happened

0

records showing who changed what

MONDAY 09:14



SANNE · SHIFT LEAD 09:14

Marta — the Antwerp load. It's on the sheet as Rotterdam. I think someone overwrote row 3 while I had it open.



MARTA 09:21

Who approved it?



SANNE 09:22

The cell says “**M.V. ✓**”. That's you. Was it you?

🙄 that's the problem



MARTA 09:26

No. And there's no way for me to prove it wasn't.



THE FILE

CHAPTER ONE · THE MONDAY

Planning_v7_FINAL.xlsx

Forty-one tabs. Built by someone in operations, years ago, on a Tuesday. It has run the depot dispatch ever since — and it works, right up until two people open it at once.



SANNE 09:40

Nobody built this to be wrong. It just got busier than it was designed for.

Planning_v7_FINAL.xlsx

41 tabs

	DEPOT	DRIVER	LOAD	APPROVED	STATUS
1	Rotterdam	J. Bakker	14t	M.V.	Confirmed
2	Antwerp	P. Claes	9t	M.V.	Confirmed
3	Antwerp	—	22t	M.V. ✓	Dispatched
4	Eindhoven	S. de Vries	11t	M.V.	Confirmed
5	Antwerp	—	—	—	—
6	Rotterdam	K. Jansen	17t	?	Pending
7	Ghent	—	8t	M.V.	Confirmed
8	Eindhoven	T. Mol	13t	??	Pending
9	Rotterdam	L. Smit	19t	M.V.	Confirmed

Row 3 — dispatched to the wrong city. Approved by “M.V.”, who did not approve it.



So Marta did something most people skip.



MARTA WED 16:02

Before I ask anyone for money, I want to know what this is actually costing us. Sanne, can you log every approval this week?



Sanne, Friday: “Eleven hours across the team. And that's just the approvals — I haven't counted the phone calls asking whether an approval happened.”

measured, not guessed

Marta tried three things. All three stalled.

ATTEMPT 01



Hire a developer

HR, WEEK 2

“Realistically four to six months to fill, and the salary band is above what operations has budgeted.”

And one developer cannot maintain a system alone anyway. **Cost and wait both bigger than the problem felt.**

ATTEMPT 02



Buy a standard tool

DEMO, WEEK 3

“It does approvals beautifully. It just can't split a load across two depots — that's not how our customers work.”

A 70% fit and a permanent workaround. **The missing 30% was the part that mattered.**

ATTEMPT 03



Have it built

MARTA, WEEK 4

“Found a small firm. Quote is fine, they seem to understand the problem. Sending it to Joost.”

This is the one that almost worked. **And then it met Finance.**



Joost de Wit
Finance Director

Then Joost asked four questions and the project stopped for three weeks.

Not because he was being difficult. Because these are the things a European company has to establish before data leaves the building — and the supplier had never been asked them before.



JOOST Q1

Which legal entity are we contracting with, and in which country?



JOOST Q2

How does the invoice work? Is it a normal intra-EU invoice or something my accountant has to research?



JOOST Q3

Where does our customer data physically sit, and who can open it?



JOOST Q4

And when are they actually available? Marta cannot run a project on replies that arrive at 07:00.



MARTA, THREE WEEKS LATER

Still waiting on two of the four. ● ● ●

We answered all four in the first email.

Not because we are clever. Because we get asked every time, so we stopped waiting to be asked.

Estonia

Nexarrow OÜ · Reg. 17521430. Verifiable in a public register.

Reverse charge

VAT EE102992676. A normal intra-EU invoice.

EU region

Hosting in the Union, DPA under EU law, access documented.

14:00–18:00

CET, every working day. In the contract.

THURSDAY 14:32 CET

NEXARROW 14:32

Joost — all four, before you ask:

1. Nexarrow OÜ, Estonia. Registry 17521430, look it up.
2. Intra-EU reverse charge. VAT EE102992676. Sample invoice attached.
3. EU region hosting. DPA attached, sub-processor list attached. Our engineers are in India and that access is documented in section 4 — we would rather you read it than discover it.
4. Live 14:00–18:00 CET, Monday to Friday. Booking link below; you can only pick a slot we are actually awake for.



JOOST 15:05

This is the first supplier who sent the DPA without me chasing it.

☒ approved to proceed

15:00 in Rotterdam. 19:30 in Pune.

Everyone assumes a team in India means overnight replies. Our evening is the European afternoon — so the call happens inside Marta's working day, every working day.



4 hrs

of real overlap, every working day

Same day

questions answered inside Marta's shift, not overnight

No 07:00

calls at awkward hours for either side

In writing

the only availability claim we make



We did not start building. We spent five days finding out what to build.

Two interviews — one with Marta, one with Sanne. Then a written map of the process, a ranked list of what was worth automating, and a costed recommendation.

NEXARROW

Two of the six things on your wish list are not worth building. One of them your existing ERP already does — nobody had switched it on.



MARTA

That's the first time a supplier has told me to buy *less*.

OPERATIONS DIAGNOSTIC

€1,900 · 5 days

Process mapped, end to end	✓
Approval logic documented	✓
Automation candidates, ranked	6 found
Worth building	4 of 6
Already possible in your ERP	1 of 6
Not worth the money	1 of 6
Recommended first build	Dispatch approvals
Costed at	€12,400 · 6 weeks

Marta kept the report. The €1,900 was credited in full against the build. If the answer had been “do nothing this year”, that would have been a real answer and we would have written it down.

In week two, Sanne clicked it and hated two things.

Which was the point. A working version went on a URL in week two — ugly, incomplete, real — specifically so the person who uses it forty times a day could complain while complaining was still cheap.



Two changes, made in week three. If Sanne had seen it in week six, both would have been “version two, next year”.



SANNE TUE 15:12

Two things. The approve button is three clicks away — on the floor I need it to be one. And it asks me for the depot every time; I only ever work one depot.

NEXARROW TUE 15:31

Both fair. One click, and the depot defaults to yours. In by Thursday.



SANNE THU 16:40

Tried it. That's better than the spreadsheet already.

👏 first real win



MARTA THU 17:02

Note for next time: ask the person who does the job, in week two, not week six.

Six weeks. Then we handed over the keys — properly.

WEEK 01

Understand

Marta and Sanne interviewed.
Scope agreed in writing.

WEEK 02

Sanne clicks it

A working version on a URL.
Two complaints, both fixed
by Thursday.

WEEK 03

The hard part

Split loads across depots —
the thing standard tools
could not do.

WEEK 04

Roles and edges

Permissions, error states,
the cases nobody mentioned
in week one.

WEEK 05

Real data

Twelve years of dispatch
history migrated and tested.

WEEK 06

Handover

Deployed, documented,
trained. The spreadsheet got
a retirement date.

WHAT MARTA GOT

- One workflow, complete and in daily use
- Roles, permissions and an audit trail
- Two integrations to existing systems
- Training for the depot teams

WHAT JOOST GOT

- Code and accounts in the company's own name
- A written architecture note in plain language
- Milestone invoicing, EU reverse charge
- A final milestone held until 30 days after go-live

WHAT SANNE GOT

- One click to approve
- Her depot pre-selected
- A record of who approved what, automatically
- The old spreadsheet switched off, with a date



THREE MONTHS LATER

The same numbers, measured again.

Marta measured before, so she could measure after. That is the only reason this slide can exist — and the reason most software projects can never prove they worked.

	BEFORE		AFTER	CHANGE
Time per approval	40 min	→	3 min	93% faster
Approvals chased twice	3 a week	→	none	eliminated
Approvals with no clear sign-off	1 in 9	→	0 of 214	fully traceable
Admin across the team	11 hrs / week	→	2 hrs / week	9 hours back
Dispatch errors	1 every 3 months	→	none since go-live	still holding

Measured over the twelve weeks after go-live, against the week Sanne logged before the build started.



Marta: “The lorry thing hasn’t happened again. But the real change is that when something does go wrong, I can see who did what in about four seconds.”

retainer signed

What just happened, in service names.

Marta never asked for “SaaS architecture” or “AI workflows”. She asked for approvals that could not be overwritten. These are the four things we do — described by what they did in her story.

SLIDES 10–12

Internal operations software

The dispatch approvals system. Where we start with almost everyone, because it is where the money leaks and where standard tools stop fitting.

- Approvals, records, audit trails
- Scheduling and dispatch
- Quoting and field data capture
- Reporting people actually open

In Marta's story: the whole build.

SLIDE 12

Cloud & reliability

Deployment in an EU region, environments, monitoring, and the release discipline that means a fix ships on Thursday rather than next month.

- EU-region hosting by default
- Preview URL for every change
- Automated tests and rollback
- Alerting that finds a human

In Marta's story: why Sanne's two changes landed in two days.

NOT YET USED

AI workflows, EU-hosted

Reading documents, drafting, retrieval — wired into a real approval path, running inside the EU, with written evidence of how it behaves.

- Document extraction, not retyping
- Retrieval over your own records
- EU-hosted models and storage
- An accuracy baseline in writing

Marta's phase two: reading supplier PDFs so nobody retypes them.

DIFFERENT CLIENTS

SaaS product foundations

For companies selling software rather than running it: multi-tenant architecture, user and billing systems, the structure that survives version four.

- Tenant-aware data model
- Roles, seats and billing flows
- Dashboards and admin tooling
- A codebase a second team can read

Same discipline, different shape of problem.

Marta's route, and the price of each step.

STEP ONE

01

Operations Diagnostic

€1,900

Five working days, mostly async

- Two interviews in your afternoon
- A written map of the process
- What is worth building, ranked
- A costed recommendation

You keep the report either way. Credited in full against a build inside 60 days.

STEP TWO

02

One workflow, built

€9.5–18k

Five to eight weeks, fixed scope

- One process, end to end
- Roles, permissions, audit trail
- Two integrations
- EU deployment and handover

Marta's came in at **€12,400**.

STEP THREE

03

Keep it alive

€3.9k /mo

Rolling, three-month minimum

- A fixed monthly hour bank
- A named engineer
- EU-afternoon availability
- A written monthly report

Where Marta is now, on **phase two**.

OR NOT AT ALL

The diagnostic stands alone

A third of the value in a project like this is deciding correctly what to build. Two of Marta's six ideas did not survive the diagnostic — one because her ERP already did it.

We would rather be the firm that told you not to spend €15,000 than the one that took it.

One thing about Marta's story.

It is a composite, not a testimonial. The dispatch mix-up, the three dead ends, Joost's four questions and Sanne's two complaints are all real patterns we have seen — assembled into one company so the shape of the problem is clear. We are not going to put a fake logo on a slide.

Nexarrow is early. You would be an early client and you should price that in. What you get in exchange is the founders on your project rather than whoever was free, and a level of attention that stops being possible at scale.

WHAT WE CAN SHOW

- Working systems you can open and click
- Architecture decisions, written down
- A fixed scope and a date before you commit

WHAT WE CANNOT, YET

- A long client list
- A ten-year record
- Anyone else to blame if it goes wrong

REAL WORK GOES HERE

Replace before sending

[Client 01 — sector, size, country]	[the number]
[Client 02]	[the number]
[Client 03]	[the number]

One line each, in Marta's format: the problem as a number, what was built, how long, and the same number afterwards.

THE EARLY-CLIENT TRADE

For our first engagements we offer a reduced rate in exchange for a named reference and permission to write the project up. If that suits you, say so — it is a fair exchange and we would rather make it explicit than dress a discount up as a promotion.

What is your spreadsheet called?

Send us the file, or the process, or the thing that keeps needing one person to hold it together. Two conversations in your afternoon and we will tell you what it would take to fix — and whether it is worth fixing at all.

If the answer is no, that is a useful afternoon for both of us.

FIVE WORKING DAYS

€1,900, CREDITED

YOU KEEP THE REPORT



MARTA, ON BEING ASKED FOR A REFERENCE

“Ask them the four questions early. If they answer all four without you chasing, the rest of it usually goes fine.”

Email	hello@nexarrow.eu
Web	nexarrow.eu
Company	Nexarrow OÜ
Registry · VAT	17521430 · EE102992676
Based	Tallinn, Estonia
Live hours	14:00–18:00 CET